

“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE”

TEXT: **Psalm 71:16-19** “I will go in the strength of the Lord God: I will make mention of thy righteousness, even of thine only. ¹⁷O God, thou hast taught me from my youth: and hitherto have I declared thy wondrous works. ¹⁸Now also when I am old and greyheaded, O God, forsake me not; until I have shewed thy strength unto this generation, and thy power to every one that is to come. ¹⁹Thy righteousness also, O God, is very high, who hast done great things: O God, who is like unto thee!”

Psalm 115:1-18 “Not unto us, O Lord, not unto us, but unto thy name give glory, for thy mercy, and for thy truth's sake. ²Wherefore should the heathen say, Where is now their God? ³But our God is in the heavens: he hath done whatsoever he hath pleased. ⁴Their idols are silver and gold, the work of men's hands. ⁵They have mouths, but they speak not: eyes have they, but they see not: ⁶They have ears, but they hear not: noses have they, but they smell not: ⁷They have hands, but they handle not: feet have they, but they walk not: neither speak they through their throat. ⁸They that make them are like unto them; so is every one that trusteth in them. ⁹O Israel, trust thou in the Lord: he is their help and their shield. ¹⁰O house of Aaron, trust in the Lord: he is their help and their shield. ¹¹Ye that fear the Lord, trust in the Lord: he is their help and their shield. ¹²The Lord hath been mindful of us: he will bless us; he will bless the house of Israel; he will bless the house of Aaron. ¹³He will bless them that fear the Lord, both small and great. ¹⁴The Lord shall increase you more and more, you and your children. ¹⁵Ye are blessed of the Lord which made heaven and earth. ¹⁶The heaven, even the heavens, are the Lord's: but the earth hath he given to the children of men. ¹⁷The dead praise not the Lord, neither any that go down into silence. ¹⁸But we will bless the Lord from this time forth and for

evermore. Praise the Lord.”

INTRO: The author of both of these Psalms is thought to be David. Psalms 71 is a prayer for help in old age. Notice verses 16-18 ***“I will go in the strength of the Lord God: I will make mention of thy righteousness, even of thine only. ¹⁷O God, thou hast taught me from my youth: and hitherto have I declared thy wondrous works. ¹⁸Now also when I am old and greyheaded, O God, forsake me not; until I have shewed thy strength unto this generation, and thy power to every one that is to come.”*** This should be the prayer of every senior saint. (Let me remind the senior saints of this Church that your example is powerful to the younger generation - good or bad!)

Here is what God intends for you to be. **Psalm 92:12-15** ***“The righteous shall flourish like the palm tree: he shall grow like a cedar in Lebanon. ¹³Those that be planted in the house of the Lord shall flourish in the courts of our God. ¹⁴They shall still bring forth fruit in old age; they shall be fat and flourishing; ¹⁵To shew that the Lord is upright: he is my rock, and there is no unrighteousness in him.”***

A righteous person should have the following things in common with a Palm tree;

- 1) Grows in dry sandy soil where there appears to be no moisture to sustain it!
- 2) Is useful, and flexible! Up to 360 uses to which it can be applied!
- 3) Has high resistance to external calamities!
- 4) Bring forth fruit in old age!

Notice in particular verse 19 ***“Thy righteousness also, O God, is very high, who hast done great things: O God, who is like unto thee!”***

I want you to pay close attention to what is being said here: He is not asking the question **“...O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO**

THEE?”

He is making a statement, **“O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!!!”**

However, in Psalms 115 David does lay out somewhat of a comparison to God! **Psalm 115:1-3** *“Not unto us, O Lord, not unto us, but unto thy name give glory, for thy mercy, and for thy truth's sake. ²Wherefore should the heathen say, Where is now their God? ³But our God is in the heavens: he hath done whatsoever he hath pleased.”* He is saying that God is much like the 2,000 pound gorilla in a man's backyard. His neighbor asked him, “what is he doing back there?” The man replied, “anything he wants to!”

Notice, David begins to draw a comparison between Jehovah, and the god's of the heathen, which are made of silver and gold!

I. THEY ARE THE WORK OF MEN'S HANDS!

A. Psalm 115:4 *“Their idols are silver and gold, the work of men's hands.”*

Can you imagine worshipping and serving a God that you created? The initial problem with these kinds of god's are, they cannot save! **Isaiah 45:20** *“Gather together and come; assemble, you fugitives from the nations. Ignorant are those who carry about idols of wood, who pray to gods that cannot save.”*

They can't save you from your sins! They can't save you from yourself! They can't save you from destruction! They can't cure you of a headache!

The second problem is that those who worship such a god, though apparently reasonably intelligent, become fools! **Romans 1:22-23** *“Although they claimed to be wise, they became fools ²³and exchanged the glory of the immortal God for images made to*

look like mortal man and birds and animals and reptiles.” These kinds of god’s are foolish, and will make a fool out of everyone that serves them! **Psalm 115:8** *“Those who make them will be like them, and so will all who trust in them.”*

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B. Rather than us making God, he made us! **Genesis 1:26-27** *“And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth. ²⁷So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them.”*

Genesis 2:7 *“And the Lord God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul.”*

These Scriptures makes us aware that God;

- 1) Created man from dust!
- 2) Created him in his own image!
- 3) Created them male and female!
- 4) Breathed into his nostrils the breath of life and man became a living soul

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The Psalmist David had this to say regarding his creators decision to make him! **Psalm 139:14** *“I will praise thee; for I am fearfully and wonderfully made: marvellous are thy works; and that my soul knoweth right well.”*

The word **“FEARFULLY”** as it is used here comes from the Hebrew word **“YARE”** (Yaw-ray’), and means reverently.

The word **“WONDERFULLY”** comes from the Hebrew word **“PALAH”** (Paw-law’), and means to distinguish, or to make differently!

What I get out of this verse is that each of us have been uniquely designed by God!

I really believe that in the creation of every human being that God steps back and with great thought, deliberately adds certain distinguishable marks or traits!
(This is true in our looks & our personalities!)

Your fingerprint is an identifiable mark that can only be traced to you! Think about that! Out of 5 Billion people alive right now your fingerprint is the only one in the world that can be traced to you!!!
No wonder David said **“O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

C. I am willing to venture a guess that no one in this house considers themselves guilty of idolatry. Before we plead completely innocent however we must realize that idolatry is anything we put before God!
(Job, family, fortune, fame, etc...)

Notice verse 8, **Psalm 115:8** ***“They that make them are like unto them; so is every one that trusteth in them.”***

The person who lives in idolatry will eventually become just like their god or god’s! They will become lifeless, and lack the creative energy that is needed to make life bearable!

On the other hand however, they that trust in the Lord will be alive, vibrant, energetic, and possess creative power as long as they live and beyond!

II. THEY HAVE MOUTHS BUT THEY SPEAK NOT!

A. **Psalm 115:5** ***“They have mouths, but they speak***

not:”

Can you imagine worshipping and serving a god who did not possess the ability to speak?

That is precisely what an overwhelming majority of this world's population is doing!

Before you start accusing people whose religious beliefs seem to be so strange and foreign, let me just tell you that there are millions of Protestant people in America who have been going to church all their lives, who have **NEVER** heard the voice of God!

B. We have record of God speaking Eleven times in the first chapter of the book of Genesis!

1) **Genesis 1:3** “*And God said, Let there be light: and there was light.*” God spoke and out of utter chaos and darkness came LIGHT!

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Think of it, LIGHT, we just take it for granted, but God “**SPOKE**” it into existence!

Genesis 1:4-5 “*And God saw the light, that it was good: and God divided the light from the darkness. ⁵And God called the light Day, and the darkness he called Night. And the evening and the morning were the first day.*”

God not only “**SPOKE**” LIGHT into existence, but he set it to traveling at a rate of 186,282 miles per second, and it has never lost any of its momentum!

2) **Genesis 1:6** “*And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.*”

The “**FIRMAMENT**” means the visible arch of the sky, or the earth’s atmosphere. The earth’s atmosphere amounts to the 100 mile expanse of sky that surrounds the earth’s surface. Within this 100 mile expanse of sky we are affected by what is known as the law of gravity. The law of gravity means that God put the earth in place in the universe, gave it a spin and told everything to stay in place!!!

Genesis 1:7-8 “*And God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament: and it was so. ⁹And God called the firmament Heaven. And the evening and the morning were the second day.*”

3) **Genesis 1:9-10** “*And God said, Let the waters under the heaven be gathered together unto one place, and let the dry land appear: and it was so. ¹⁰And God called the dry land Earth; and the gathering together of the waters called he Seas: and God saw that it was good.*”

At least 75% of the earth surface is covered by water! There are three great oceans, the Atlantic, Indian, and Pacific. These three Oceans alone cover 123,686,000 square miles of the earth’s surface!

The God that we serve put the mighty oceans in their boundaries on the third day of creation and told them to stay there, and thousands of years later they are still where he put them! **Jeremiah 5:22** “*... God placed the sand for the bound of the sea by a perpetual decree, that it cannot pass it: and though the waves thereof toss themselves, yet can they not prevail; though they roar, yet can they not pass over it?*”

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4) Placing the seas in their boundaries seems to me quite a plausible

day's work but notice verses 11-13, **Genesis 1:11-13** "And God said, Let the earth bring forth grass, the herb yielding seed, and the fruit tree yielding fruit after his kind, whose seed is in itself, upon the earth: and it was so. ¹²And the earth brought forth grass, and herb yielding seed after his kind, and the tree yielding fruit, whose seed was in itself, after his kind: and God saw that it was good. ¹³And the evening and the morning were the third day."

Think of it, on the afternoon of the third day of creation God spoke all manner of vegetation into existence!

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5) **Genesis 1:14-15** "And God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days, and years: ¹⁵And let them be for lights in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth: and it was so."

Wait a minute, this is the fourth day of creation and the earth has been lighted since the first day! Please notice that it is not until the Fourth day of creation that the sun, moon, stars, planets, and galaxies were created! **Genesis 1:16-18** "And God made two great lights; the greater light to rule the day, and the lesser light to rule the night: he made the stars also. ¹⁷And God set them in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth, ¹⁸And to rule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the darkness: and God saw that it was good."

How many stars are there? If you walk outside on a clear night you can see clearly approximately 3,000 stars! If you had a telescope

with a lens Three inches thick you could see approximately 600,000 stars! The largest telescopes make it possible to see about Three Billion individual stars!

How big is this universe that God created? It is so big that it takes light traveling at the rate of 186,282 miles per second more than 80,000 years to reach the most distant stars in the Milky Way! The Milky Way's closest neighbor is a Galaxy 200,000 light years away! We know of stars that are Billions of light years from the Milky Way!

Isaiah 40:12 *"Who has measured the waters in the hollow of his hand, or with the breadth of his hand marked off the heavens? Who has held the dust of the earth in a basket, or weighed the mountains on the scales and the hills in a balance?"*

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6) Genesis 1:20-21 *"And God said, Let the waters bring forth abundantly the moving creature that hath life, and fowl that may fly above the earth in the open firmament of heaven."*²¹*And God created great whales, and every living creature that moveth, which the waters brought forth abundantly, after their kind, and every winged fowl after his kind: and God saw that it was good."*

When God spoke the fish of the sea and the fowl of the air were created!

Think of it every species known to man that swims in an ocean, lake, or stream, every bird that fly's through the air, on the fifth day of creation God spoke them into existence!

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7) **Genesis 1:22-23** “And God blessed them, saying, Be fruitful, and multiply, and fill the waters in the seas, and let fowl multiply in the earth. ²³And the evening and the morning were the fifth day.”

If God had not spoken these words the fish of the sea and the fowl of the air would have been sterile, and in just a little while would have been extinct! It was the word of God that gave them reproductive power!

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8) **Genesis 1:24-25** “And God said, Let the earth bring forth the living creature after his kind, cattle, and creeping thing, and beast of the earth after his kind: and it was so. ²⁵And God made the beast of the earth after his kind, and cattle after their kind, and every thing that creepeth upon the earth after his kind: and God saw that it was good.”

On the sixth day of creation God made every species of beast that lives on planet Earth and gave the power to reproduce after their kind!

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9) **Genesis 1:26-27** “And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth. ²⁷So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them.”

It was on the Sixth day of creation that God created man in his own

likeness!

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10) **Genesis 1:28** *“And God blessed them, and God said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over every living thing that moveth upon the earth.”*

In addition, on the Sixth day of creation God gave humans reproductive power! You can't look at a new born baby without thinking, **“O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

11) **Genesis 1:29-30** *“And God said, Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, and every tree, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you it shall be for meat. ³⁰And to every beast of the earth, and to every fowl of the air, and to every thing that creepeth upon the earth, wherein there is life, I have given every green herb for meat: and it was so.”*

God gave man dominion over the Earth!

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C. This is just the first chapter of the Bible!!!

The god's of this world have mouths but they cannot speak!

Our God not only speaks, but he gets results!

“O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Remember, “They that make them are like unto them; so is every one that trusteth in them.”

The god’s of this world “... *Have mouths, but they speak not!*”

Mark 1:21-28 “*And they went into Capernaum; and straightway on the sabbath day he entered into the synagogue, and taught. ²²And they were astonished at his doctrine: for he taught them as one that had authority, and not as the scribes. ²³And there was in their synagogue a man with an unclean spirit; and he cried out, ²⁴Saying, Let us alone; what have we to do with thee, thou Jesus of Nazareth? art thou come to destroy us? I know thee who thou art, the Holy One of God. ²⁵And Jesus rebuked him, saying, Hold thy peace, and come out of him. ²⁶And when the unclean spirit had torn him, and cried with a loud voice, he came out of him. ²⁷And they were all amazed, insomuch that they questioned among themselves, saying, What thing is this? what new doctrine is this? for with authority commandeth he even the unclean spirits, and they do obey him. ²⁸And immediately his fame spread abroad throughout all the region round about Galilee.”*

Remember, Jesus performed this not as an equal with God, but as the Son of God! You and I can receive the same power!

III. THEY HAVE EYES BUT THEY SEE NOT!

A. The Bible speaks of people following “**BLIND**” guides, of course I cannot imagine a thing like that, and yet here he is saying that the god’s of the heathen are “**BLIND**” and cannot see!

Can you imagine having a god to give you direction that cannot “**SEE**” into the future?

Thus the problem with much of this secular world, they are serving

god's that do not have the benefit of "SEEING" down the road!

A god who cannot see, cannot;
Give good advice!
Give good direction!
Lead without stumbling!

The sad part of this is, **Psalm 115:8** "***Those who make them will be like them, and so will all who trust in them.***"

Do you want to just hobble through life void of the direction of a God with an "ALL SEEING EYE", or do you want his "EYE" guiding you each step of the way?

B. The god's of this world cannot "SEE" what is going to happen this afternoon, let alone what will happen Ten years from now!

So the question must be asked, what is God's "VISION" like? John the Revelator described his "EYES" in this way: **Rev. 1:14** "***... his eyes were as a flame of fire;***"

Our God has "EYES" with "X-RAY VISION"! The "X-RAY VISION" of our God is used to find a way to help and bless his people! **2 Chron. 16:9** "***For the eyes of the Lord run to and fro throughout the whole earth, to shew himself strong in the behalf of them whose heart is perfect toward him...***" Not only does our God have "EYES" but his "EYES" are constantly on the lookout for someone who will allow him to bless them! **"O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!"**

The "EYES" of the Lord give direction when we do not know which way to turn! **Isaiah 42:8-9** "***I am the Lord: that is my name: and my glory will I not give to another, neither my praise to graven images. Behold, the former things are come to pass, and new things do I declare:***"

before they spring forth I tell you of them.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE”

God has a vantage point that allows him to “SEE” the end from the beginning! **Isaiah 46:9-10** *“Remember the former things of old: for I am God, and there is none else; I am God, and there is none like me, ¹⁰Declaring the end from the beginning, and from ancient times the things that are not yet done, saying, My counsel shall stand, and I will do all my pleasure:” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”*

C. The Scripture makes us aware that those who create false god’s become like them. That makes me know that if my Heavenly father has “VISION” that can “SEE” past the here and now, he probably intended for his children to have supernatural “VISION” as well!

Daniel in interpreting Nebuchadnezzar’s dreams say’s, **Daniel 2:19-23** *“Then was the secret revealed unto Daniel in a night vision. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven. ²⁰Daniel answered and said, Blessed be the name of God for ever and ever: for wisdom and might are his: ²¹And he changeth the times and the seasons: he removeth kings, and setteth up kings: he giveth wisdom unto the wise, and knowledge to them that know understanding: ²²He revealeth the deep and secret things: he knoweth what is in the darkness, and the light dwelleth with him. ²³I thank thee, and praise thee, O thou God of my fathers, who hast given me wisdom and might, and hast made known unto me now what we desired of thee: for thou hast now made known unto us the king's matter.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”*

It is the will of God to “REVEAL” things unto his people, that have somehow alluded the most intellectual minds on Earth! **Amos 3:7** *“Surely the Lord God will do nothing, but he revealeth his*

secret unto his servants the prophets.”

John 15:15 “Henceforth I call you not servants; for the servant knoweth not what his lord doeth: but I have called you friends; for all things that I have heard of my Father I have made known unto you.”
“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE”

How is this kind of keen “VISION” available to us? 1 Cor. 2:9-16 “But as it is written, Eye hath not seen, nor ear heard, neither have entered into the heart of man, the things which God hath prepared for them that love him. ¹⁰But God hath revealed them unto us by his Spirit: for the Spirit searcheth all things, yea, the deep things of God. ¹¹For what man knoweth the things of a man, save the spirit of man which is in him? even so the things of God knoweth no man, but the Spirit of God. ¹²Now we have received, not the spirit of the world, but the spirit which is of God; that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God. ¹³Which things also we speak, not in the words which man's wisdom teacheth, but which the Holy Ghost teacheth; comparing spiritual things with spiritual. ¹⁴But the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God: for they are foolishness unto him: neither can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned. ¹⁵But he that is spiritual judgeth all things, yet he himself is judged of no man. ¹⁶For who hath known the mind of the Lord, that he may instruct him? But we have the mind of Christ.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

We have a choice to make; Travel through life like a blind man, or allow God to illuminate our pathway! Psalm 119:105
“Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.”

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IV. THEY HAVE EARS BUT THEY HEAR NOT!

A. Can you imagine serving a god who does not possess the ability to **“HEAR”**?

We have become so accustomed to serving a God who stands ready to respond to our every need that I am not sure we can even imagine trying to deal with a god who cannot **“HEAR”**!

If the god you serve cannot hear;
He cannot communicate without an interpreter! That is precisely how the gods of this world operate, someone else must communicate for them! (Dead religion necessitates an intermediary!)

Communication is never complete until the person who has initiated the contact has spoken, and the person being spoken to has responded, and each understands the other!

If he cannot **“HEAR”**, he has no way of knowing what you need!

If he cannot **“HEAR”** he cannot respond!
Think of the most desperate hour of your life, can you imagine dealing with that particular problem knowing that God cannot **“HEAR”**!

B. The Scripture makes us aware that those who create or serve gods such as this become like unto them!
They quickly become hearing impaired!

If they continue in idolatry they will eventually become completely **“DEAF”**, unable to hear the voice of God!

At this point they are a prime candidate to be deceived to the point of believing a lie and being damned!

They get to the point that they don't believe they can communicate with God without an intermediary!

They begin to believe that there is no reason to present a need to God, because they assume that he is as “**DEAF**” as they are!

When this scenario is played to it's final conclusion they begin to believe that if God can “**HEAR**”, he will not respond!

C. Unlike the god's of this world, our God “**HEAR'S**” and answers prayer! **Luke 11:9-10** “*And I say unto you, Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you. ¹⁰For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.*”

Psalm 91:15 “*He shall call upon me, and I will answer him: I will be with him in trouble; I will deliver him, and honour him.*”

John 15:7 “*If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.*”

Isaiah 65:24 “*And it shall come to pass, that before they call, I will answer; and while they are yet speaking, I will hear.*”

Aren't you thankful that we serve a God who not only “**HEAR'S**”, but also answers?

V. THEY HAVE NOSES, BUT THEY SMELL NOT!

A. Of all these comparisons to our God this one seems to be the strangest of them all! What does a “**NOSE**”, and the sense of “**SMELL**” have to do with God anyway?

Forty Four times the Old Testament uses the word “**SAVOUR**”

when describing the flesh of a burnt offering burning before the Lord. The same word is used when describing incense burning upon the Altar of God.

Old Testament worship was characterized by unique odors. (Flesh burning upon the Altars of Israel, Incense burning in the worship place.)

Almost always the word “SAVOUR” is preceded by the word “SWEET”! (Only four of Forty Four times does the word “SWEET” fail to appear before the word “SAVOUR”!)

The word “SAVOUR” is used on a very limited basis in the New Testament. It appears only Seven times. Of that Seven times, Five times it refers to the sense of “SMELL”, and is preceded by the word “SWEET” only Twice.

The word “SAVOUR” comes from the Hebrew word “REYACH” (ray’-akh), and means an odor, scent, or smell, as if being blown through the air!

The word “SWEET” comes from the Hebrew word “NIYCHOWACH” (nee-kho’-akh), and means a pleasant odor!

B. In Old Testament worship the burning of flesh upon the altars, and the offering of incense in the worship was said to be a “SWEET” smelling “SAVOUR” in the “NOSTRILS” of Jehovah God!

In the New Testament we are told that it is our worship that becomes a “SWEET SMELLING SAVOUR” in the “NOSTRILS” of God!

According to 2 Corinthians 2:14-15 when we receive and dispense the knowledge of God in this earth we are sending up a “SWEET” smelling “SAVOUR” into the “NOSTRILS” of God! *“But thanks be to God, who always leads us in triumphal procession in Christ and through us spreads everywhere the fragrance of the knowledge of him. ¹⁵For we are to God the aroma of Christ (A*

sweet savour of Christ)among those who are being saved and those who are perishing.”

According to Ephesians 5:1-2 the sacrifice of Jesus was a **“SWEET SMELLING SAVOUR”** before God! The way we stir up a **“SMELL”** that God would be pleased with is by walking in love with fellow laborers, and being willing and ready to offer our lives sacrificially to God and others, without complaint! ***“Be imitators of God, therefore, as dearly loved children and live a life of love, just as Christ loved us and gave himself up for us as a sweet smelling sacrifice to God.”***

We are also told that our prayers and our praise comes up as a **“SWEET SMELLING SAVOUR”** in the **“NOSTRILS”** of God!

The best way I know to describe what I am talking about is to offer an illustration that everyone can identify with:

ILLUSTRATION: Going outside on a beautiful spring afternoon and about half a dozen of your neighbors are cooking outdoors. This will make you want to fire up your grill and do likewise. It will make you hungry when you are full! It makes you want to get involved! It makes you want to invite yourself over!

When we receive and dispense the knowledge of God in our world, it causes an aroma that entices God to get involved in what we are doing!

When we choose to operate in love when we have other options available to us, it creates an aroma that causes God to want to participate in our lives!

Every time we do something voluntarily sacrificial, and maintain a proper attitude it stirs up an aroma that automatically attracts the presence of God!

A scent arises from our prayers and praises, that gets Gods attention

immediately! **“O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE?”**

C. The god’s of the heathens have “NOSES, BUT THEY SMELL NOT”!

With the god’s of this world it doesn’t matter how much their followers know about them, or share about them, they are not going to pay attention because they cannot **“SMELL”** the fragrance of the dedication of their followers!

It doesn’t matter how loving, gentle, good and kind the followers of the god’s of this world are, their god will not notice because their sense of **“SMELL”** is dead!

Many people have laid down their lives for the gods of this world without any reward, because their god could not **“SMELL”** the aroma of sacrifice!

All over the world, people are kneeling and praying three times a day to a god whose sense of **“SMELL”** is dead to the aroma of prayer and praise!

Psalm 115:8 *“They that **make them are like unto them**; so is every one that **trusteth in them**.”*

They are like them in the following way’s;

- 1) No one can be dedicated enough to suit them!**
- 2) No one but that individual is ever kind enough to pass the test!**
- 3) No one else’s sacrifice is ever good enough!**
- 4) No one else’s worship is ever what they think it ought to be!**

When we receive and dispense the knowledge of God, operate in love, sacrifice, pray, or praise God the scent of it causes God to get involved! **“O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE?”**

When God get’s involved:
Knowledge becomes reality!

Faith becomes sight!

Love in spite of the circumstances, becomes the order of the day!

Sacrifice becomes worship!

Prayer becomes a priority!

Praise becomes infectious!

“O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

VI. THEY HAVE HANDS, BUT THEY HANDLE NOT!

A. As I read this verse the first thing I see is that an idol is a **“HANDS OFF”** kind of god!

I can tell you that I do not want to be a **“HANDS OFF”** husband, father, pastor, or any thing else for that part!

What I conclude from this statement is that a god who takes a **“HANDS OFF”** approach to his relationship with you will fail to get involved in the details of your life!

Could you deal with all your present problems and the thought of all your tomorrow's, if you knew that in the midst of your worst dilemmas the god to whom you pray was going to take a **“HANDS OFF”** approach to all your difficulties?

That is exactly what millions of people worldwide are doing this very minute! Not all of them are crying out to a little pot bellied statue, or praying to Mary, many of them are setting in Pentecostal churches this morning! (Whatever you have place between you and God, has become the God at whose altar you are worshipping!)

B. I am extremely grateful that I serve a God who takes a **“HANDS ON”** approach to all the things that affect my life. [Genesis](#)

28:15 “And, behold, I am with thee, and will keep thee in all places whither thou goest, and will bring thee again into this land; for I will not leave thee, until I have done that which I have spoken to thee of.”

Hebrews 13:5 “Let your conversation be without covetousness; and be content with such things as ye have: for he hath said, I will never leave thee, nor forsake thee.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Psalms 27:10 “When my father and my mother forsake me, then the Lord will take me up.”

Luke 12:6-7 “Are not five sparrows sold for two farthings, and not one of them is forgotten before God? But even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. Fear not therefore: ye are of more value than many sparrows.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

I don't mind telling you that I have a big enough struggle at times in my life maintaining victory with a “HANDS ON” God, let alone trying to serve a god with a “HANDS OFF” approach.

Much is said in the scripture about the “HAND” of God!

When the lice fell upon Egypt: **Exodus 8:19** “Then the magicians said unto Pharaoh, This is the finger of God: and Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he hearkened not unto them; as the Lord had said.”

Moses upon Mt. Sinai: **Exodus 31:18** “And he gave unto Moses, when he had made an end of communing with him upon mount Sinai, two tables of testimony, tables of stone, written with the finger of God.”

Psalm 8:3-4 *"When I consider thy heavens, the work of thy fingers, the moon and the stars, which thou hast ordained; ⁴What is man, that thou art mindful of him? and the son of man, that thou visitest him?"*

In Daniel five while Belshazzar was throwing a drunken party and drinking out of the vessels from the Temple, God's fingers began to write upon the plaster of the wall and said, **Daniel 5:26-28** *"...God hath numbered thy kingdom, and finished it... Thou art weighed in the balances, and art found wanting... Thy kingdom is divided, and given to the Medes and Persians."*

In Luke 11 Jesus has just cast out a devil and is being questioned concerning the authority upon which he has done this! He responds **Luke 11:17-23** ***"But he, knowing their thoughts, said unto them, Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation; and a house divided against a house falleth. ¹⁸If Satan also be divided against himself, how shall his kingdom stand? because ye say that I cast out devils through Beelzebub. ¹⁹And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your sons cast them out? therefore shall they be your judges. ²⁰But if I with the finger of God cast out devils, no doubt the kingdom of God is come upon you. ²¹When a strong man armed keepeth his palace, his goods are in peace: ²²But when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome him, he taketh from him all his armour wherein he trusted, and divideth his spoils. ²³He that is not with me is against me: and he that gathereth not with me scattereth."***

I want us to look at three things that the Word of God say's the **"HAND"** of God will do in our lives; (1) It will be mighty! (2) It will be upon us for blessing! (3) It will be upon us for chastisement!

It will be mighty! **Deut. 5:15** *“And remember that thou wast a servant in the land of Egypt, and that the Lord thy God brought thee out thence through a mighty hand and by a stretched out arm; therefore the Lord thy God.”*
“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Isaiah 59:1 *“Behold, the Lord's hand is not shortened, that it cannot save; neither his ear heavy, that it cannot hear:”* **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

Psalms 98:1 *“O sing unto the Lord a new song; for he hath done marvellous things: his right hand, and his holy arm, hath gotten him the victory.”*

If it got him the victory, it will surely get us the victory!

Romans 8:31-39 *“What shall we then say to these things? If God be for us, who can be against us? ³²He that spared not his own Son, but delivered him up for us all, how shall he not with him also freely give us all things? ³³Who shall lay any thing to the charge of God's elect? It is God that justifieth. ³⁴Who is he that condemneth? It is Christ that died, yea rather, that is risen again, who is even at the right hand of God, who also maketh intercession for us. ³⁵Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶As it is written, For thy sake we are killed all the day long; we are accounted as sheep for the slaughter. ³⁷Nay, in all these things we are more than conquerors through him that loved us. ³⁸For I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come, ³⁹Nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus*

our Lord”

1 Peter 5:6 “Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time:”
“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

The “HAND” of God has been mighty in the past, and will be mighty in the present and the future!

The “HAND” of God is upon us for blessing! **Psalm 37:23-25**

“The steps of a good man are ordered by the Lord: and he delighteth in his way. ²⁴Though he fall, he shall not be utterly cast down: for the Lord upholdeth him with his hand. ²⁵I have been young, and now am old; yet have I not seen the righteous forsaken, nor his seed begging bread.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Psalm 104:27-28 “These wait all upon thee; that thou mayest give them their meat in due season. ²⁸That thou givest them they gather: thou openest thine hand, they are filled with good.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!” (Having something for my children in one fist, and having them to choose which one it is in - one is always empty, and sometimes they choose the empty hand! My father has something good in both of his hands!)

Isaiah 49:16 “Behold, I have graven thee upon the palms of my hands; thy walls are continually before me.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Deut. 28:1-14 “If you fully obey the Lord your God and carefully follow all his commands I give you today, the Lord your God will set you high above all the nations on earth. ²All these blessings will come upon you and accompany you if you obey the Lord your God: ³You will be blessed in the city and blessed in the country. ⁴The fruit of your womb will be

blessed, and the crops of your land and the young of your livestock, the calves of your herds and the lambs of your flocks. ⁵Your basket and your kneading trough will be blessed. ⁶You will be blessed when you come in and blessed when you go out. ⁷The Lord will grant that the enemies who rise up against you will be defeated before you. They will come at you from one direction but flee from you in seven. ⁸The Lord will send a blessing on your barns and on everything you put your hand to. The Lord your God will bless you in the land he is giving you. ⁹The Lord will establish you as his holy people, as he promised you on oath, if you keep the commands of the Lord your God and walk in his ways. Then all the peoples on earth will see that you are called by the name of the Lord, and they will fear you. **10**Then all the peoples on earth will see that you are called by the name of the Lord, and they will fear you.

¹¹The Lord will grant you abundant prosperity--in the fruit of your womb, the young of your livestock and the crops of your ground--in the land he swore to your forefathers to give you.

¹²The Lord will open the heavens, the storehouse of his bounty, to send rain on your land in season and to bless all the work of your hands. You will lend to many nations but will borrow from none. ¹³The Lord will make you the head, not the tail. If you pay attention to the commands of the Lord your God that I give you this day and carefully follow them, you will always be at the top, never at the bottom. ¹⁴Do not turn aside from any of the commands I give you today, to the right or to the left, following other gods and serving them.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Nine times in Fourteen verses the writer say's that it is the good pleasure of the Heavenly Father to lay his “**HAND**” of “**BLESSING**” upon his people! I believe God wants to “**BLESS**” us don't you?

The gods of the heathen take a “**HANDS OFF**” approach

toward those who serve them, but our God takes a “**HANDS ON**” approach toward us! “**O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!**”

The “**HAND**” of God can also be upon us for chastisement! Now I must admit that I do not relish the idea of the chastisement of God in my life! (My Dad broke me from looking forward to chastisement!) (Picking my own switch!)

God’s word say’s that if we really love our children we will chastise them when the situation warrants it! **Proverbs 13:24** “*He that spareth his rod hateth his son: but he that loveth him chasteneth him betimes.* (early)” (Better late than never!)

Deut. 8:5 “*Thou shalt also consider in thine heart, that, as a man chasteneth his son, so the Lord thy God chasteneth thee.*”

Please understand that the perfect will of God is to “**BLESS**” us, however if we disobey him he will surely “**CHASTISE**” us because he loves us! The very same passage of scripture that so emphatically states God’s desire to “**BLESS**” us say’s that if we disobey he will “**CURSE**” us! **Deut. 28:15-45** “*But it shall come to pass, if thou wilt not hearken unto the voice of the Lord thy God, to observe to do all his commandments and his statutes which I command thee this day; that all these curses shall come upon thee, and overtake thee: ¹⁶Cursed shalt thou be in the city, and cursed shalt thou be in the field. ¹⁷Cursed shall be thy basket and thy store. ¹⁸Cursed shall be the fruit of thy body, and the fruit of thy land, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep. ¹⁹Cursed shalt thou be when thou comest in, and cursed shalt thou be when thou goest out. ²⁰The Lord shall send upon thee cursing, vexation, and rebuke, in all that thou settest thine hand unto for to do, until thou be destroyed, and until thou*

perish quickly; because of the wickedness of thy doings, whereby thou hast forsaken me. ²¹The Lord shall make the pestilence cleave unto thee, until he have consumed thee from off the land, whither thou goest to possess it. ²²The Lord shall smite thee with a consumption, and with a fever, and with an inflammation, and with an extreme burning, and with the sword, and with blasting, and with mildew; and they shall pursue thee until thou perish. ²³And thy heaven that is over thy head shall be brass, and the earth that is under thee shall be iron. ²⁴The Lord shall make the rain of thy land powder and dust: from heaven shall it come down upon thee, until thou be destroyed. ²⁵The Lord shall cause thee to be smitten before thine enemies: thou shalt go out one way against them, and flee seven ways before them: and shalt be removed into all the kingdoms of the earth. ²⁶And thy carcase shall be meat unto all fowls of the air, and unto the beasts of the earth, and no man shall fray them away. ²⁷The Lord will smite thee with the botch of Egypt, and with the emerods, and with the scab, and with the itch, whereof thou canst not be healed. ²⁸The Lord shall smite thee with madness, and blindness, and astonishment of heart: ²⁹And thou shalt grope at noonday, as the blind gropeth in darkness, and thou shalt not prosper in thy ways: and thou shalt be only oppressed and spoiled evermore, and no man shall save thee. ³⁰Thou shalt betroth a wife, and another man shall lie with her: thou shalt build an house, and thou shalt not dwell therein: thou shalt plant a vineyard, and shalt not gather the grapes thereof. ³¹Thine ox shall be slain before thine eyes, and thou shalt not eat thereof: thine ass shall be violently taken away from before thy face, and shall not be restored to thee: thy sheep shall be given unto thine enemies, and thou shalt have none to rescue them. ³²Thy sons and thy daughters shall be given unto another people, and thine eyes shall look, and fail with longing for them all the day long: and there shall be no might in thine hand. ³³The fruit of thy land, and all thy labours, shall a nation which thou knowest not eat up; and thou shalt be only oppressed and crushed alway: ³⁴So that thou shalt be mad for the sight of thine eyes which thou shalt see.

³⁵The Lord shall smite thee in the knees, and in the legs, with a sore botch that cannot be healed, from the sole of thy foot unto the top of thy head. ³⁶The Lord shall bring thee, and thy king which thou shalt set over thee, unto a nation which neither thou nor thy fathers have known; and there shalt thou serve other gods, wood and stone. ³⁷And thou shalt become an astonishment, a proverb, and a byword, among all nations whither the Lord shall lead thee. ³⁸Thou shalt carry much seed out into the field, and shalt gather but little in; for the locust shall consume it. ³⁹Thou shalt plant vineyards, and dress them, but shalt neither drink of the wine, nor gather the grapes; for the worms shall eat them. ⁴⁰Thou shalt have olive trees throughout all thy coasts, but thou shalt not anoint thyself with the oil; for thine olive shall cast his fruit. ⁴¹Thou shalt beget sons and daughters, but thou shalt not enjoy them; for they shall go into captivity. ⁴²All thy trees and fruit of thy land shall the locust consume. ⁴³The stranger that is within thee shall get up above thee very high; and thou shalt come down very low. ⁴⁴He shall lend to thee, and thou shalt not lend to him: he shall be the head, and thou shalt be the tail. ⁴⁵Moreover all these curses shall come upon thee, and shall pursue thee, and overtake thee, till thou be destroyed; because thou hearkenedst not unto the voice of the Lord thy God, to keep his commandments and his statutes which he commanded thee:”

When Father God takes a “HANDS ON” approach in the area of “CHASTISEMENT” it is always corrective in nature and never punitive! (It took me a long time to realize the reason my father was correcting me is because he loved me! I must admit, it didn’t feel much like love!)

“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

C. Notice once again **Psalm 115:8** *“They that make them are like unto them; so is every one that trusteth in them.”*

The gods of this world are insensitive to the needs of others to the point that they are **“HANDS OFF”**, and selfish! This scripture lets us know that those who serve them or trust in them become like unto them!

Is that how you desire to live your life?

VII. THEY HAVE FEET, BUT THEY WALK NOT!

A. All of the study that I have done suggests that the **“FEET”** of a god is representative of a place where his followers come to worship!

If the gods of the heathen **“HAVE FEET, BUT WALK NOT”**, that indicates that those who would worship there, are worshipping at a dead shrine!

If the gods of the heathen have **“FEET”** but cannot **“WALK”** that means they are **“IMMOBILE”**.

I submit to you that an **“IMMOBILE”** god;

Cannot come to where you are! (Marriage, children, spiritual, financial, etc...) Wherever he is at, he is stationary in that place unless you carry him with you, of your own power!

Cannot help you with your problems! Even if he could diagnose your problem he could do nothing about it!

Cannot carry your burdens!

Cannot move about, to chase off your enemies!

B. On the other hand, the Word of God has much to say about the **“FEET”** of God, and the **“FOOTSTOOL”** of God!

When John saw Jesus on the Isle of Patmos he had this to say about him: **Rev. 1:10-20** *“I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and*

*heard behind me a great voice, as of a trumpet, ¹¹Saying, I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last: and, What thou seest, write in a book, and send it unto the seven churches which are in Asia; unto Ephesus, and unto Smyrna, and unto Pergamos, and unto Thyatira, and unto Sardis, and unto Philadelphia, and unto Laodicea. ¹²And I turned to see the voice that spake with me. And being turned, I saw seven golden candlesticks; ¹³And in the midst of the seven candlesticks one like unto the Son of man, clothed with a garment down to the foot, and girt about the paps with a golden girdle. ¹⁴His head and his hairs were white like wool, as white as snow; and his eyes were as a flame of fire; ¹⁵And his feet like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace; and his voice as the sound of many waters. ¹⁶And he had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword: and his countenance was as the sun shineth in his strength. ¹⁷And when I saw him, I fell at his feet as dead. And he laid his right hand upon me, saying unto me, **Fear not; I am the first and the last: ¹⁸I am he that liveth, and was dead; and, behold, I am alive for evermore, Amen; and have the keys of hell and of death. ¹⁹Write the things which thou hast seen, and the things which are, and the things which shall be hereafter; ²⁰The mystery of the seven stars which thou sawest in my right hand, and the seven golden candlesticks. The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches: and the seven candlesticks which thou sawest are the seven churches.**” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”*

When King David was about to relinquish the throne of his Kingdom to his son Solomon he say's, **1 Chron. 28:2** “*Then David the king stood up upon his feet, and said, Hear me, my brethren, and my people: As for me, I had in mine heart to build*

an house of rest for the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and for the footstool of our God..."

Again the Psalmist say's, **Psalm 99:5** "*Exalt ye the Lord our God, and worship at his footstool; for he is holy.*" "**GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!**"

The Lord speaks through the Prophet Isaiah and say's, **Isaiah 66:1** "*Thus saith the Lord, The heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool: where is the house that ye build unto me? and where is the place of my rest?*"

The God that we serve has "**FEET**", and is very "**MOBILE**". In fact his is omnipresent! He is everywhere at all times!

Because of this our God;

Can come where you are! My experience has been that there are many times that I have been devoid of the strength required to go to where God can be found, and I have a desperate need for him to come to where I am! (Marriage, children, spiritual, financial, etc...)

Maybe you have never been so down, discouraged, and distraught that you could not seem to move into his presence, but I have been there! (I said God this is Don, and I thought I heard him say, Don who?)

The God that we serve has been known to leave 99 sheep in the fold and go looking for one lost lamb!

In addition the scripture makes us aware that he searches until he finds it, and lays it on his own shoulders and carries it home! We don't have to carry God, he will carry us! (Poem: Footprints)

Once he get's it home it is **PARTY TIME!** (Prodigal Son! Luke

15) “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Can help you with your problems! **Deut. 33:26-29**

“There is none like unto the God of Jeshurun (yesh-oo-roon’), who rideth upon the heaven in thy help, and in his excellency on the sky. ²⁷The eternal God is thy refuge, and underneath are the everlasting arms: and he shall thrust out the enemy from before thee; and shall say, Destroy them. ²⁸Israel then shall dwell in safety alone: the fountain of Jacob shall be upon a land of corn and wine; also his heavens shall drop down dew. ²⁹Happy art thou, O Israel: who is like unto thee, O people saved by the Lord, the shield of thy help, and who is the sword of thy excellency! and thine enemies shall be found liars unto thee; and thou shalt tread upon their high places.” “O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

Can carry your burden! **2 Cor. 5:4** “For while we are in this tent, we groan and are burdened, because we do not wish to be unclothed but to be clothed with our heavenly dwelling, so that what is mortal may be swallowed up by life.”

Jesus said in **John 16:33** “**These things I have spoken unto you, that in me ye might have peace. In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.”**

Psalms 44:1-7 “We have heard with our ears, O God; our fathers have told us what you did in their days, in days long ago. With your hand you drove out the nations and planted our fathers; you crushed the peoples and made our fathers flourish. ³It was not by their sword that they won the land, nor did their arm bring them victory; it was your right

hand, your arm, and the light of your face, for you loved them ⁴*You are my King and my God, who decrees victories for Jacob.* ⁵*Through you we push back our enemies; through your name we trample our foes.* ⁶*I do not trust in my bow, my sword does not bring me victory; but you give us victory over our enemies, you put our adversaries to shame.*”

I will tell you right now that I am no match for the enemy! I don't have to be because my God is going to carry my burdens for me! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

SONG: “Take these burdens and do what only you can do!”

Can move about and chase off your enemies! **Psalm 68:1** *“Let God arise, let his enemies be scattered: let them also that hate him flee before him.”*

Not only does our God have **“FEET”**, he is also very **“MOBILE”**!

When the enemy is coming against us, I can almost hear God saying to the enemy, **“DON'T MAKE ME GET UP”**! (When my earthly father said this to me I knew I had pushed him as far as he was going to be pushed!)

The scattering of the enemy is God's plan for dismantling the malignant forces that come against the believer!

Scattering the enemy breaks up his power base so that his intensity is fragmented and his designs are thwarted!

The enemy may come at you one way, but when God arises to confront him, he will flee before you seven ways! **Deut. 28:7** *“The Lord shall cause thine enemies that rise up against*

thee to be smitten before thy face: they shall come out against thee one way, and flee before thee seven ways.

When you see organized opposition, collective hostility, and the enemy marshaling his forces to come against the cause of righteousness, know that God will step in and bring to naught the devious plot of the adversary!

God is our father, and gets in the middle of our situations with the enemy and tells him to get lost!

Our enemy is his enemy! Our battle becomes his battle!
Ultimately, his victory becomes my victory! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

C. Notice again **Psalm 115:8** ***“They that make them are like unto them; so is every one that trusteth in them.”***

The gods of this world are **“IMMOBILE”**, they are restricted, and do not adapt to change very well! The Bible says that those who **“MAKE THEM”**, or **“TRUST IN THEM”** will **“BECOME LIKE THEM”**!

The choice is yours become like your heavenly father, or like the gods of this world!

VIII. NEITHER SPEAK THEY THROUGH THEIR THROAT!

A. Can you imagine serving a god who does not have the capacity to **“SPEAK”**?

In the second sermon of this series we talked about the fact that a major part of the population of the world is doing exactly that!

The truly sad part of this is that there are hundreds of thousands of people who are sitting in Christian churches all over America who

have never heard God **“SAY”** one word? Why have they not heard?

Could it be because God is not **“SPEAKING”**? I don’t think so.

In the second sermon of this series we also learned that God **“SPOKE”** no less than eleven times in the first chapter of the Bible!

So why aren’t people hearing from God? In order to answer that question, you must first discover how God goes about **“SPEAKING”** to us!

He **“SPEAKS”** to us through his word! From Genesis to Revelation the voice of God can be heard. In fact he **“SPEAKS”** with authority on every subject known to man! (Sin, Salvation, health, relationships, habits, romance, occupations, sowing, reaping, etc...)

The Psalmist said that God **“SPEAKS”** to us ***“through his throat”***! I take that to mean that he not only **“SPEAKS”** to us through his word, but that he also **“SPEAKS”** with his voice, into a listening ear!

People say they want to hear from God, but I’m not sure they are as sincere as they seem. What they are really **“SAYING”** is that they want someone to lay their hand upon them and **“SPEAK”** a word over them! Please understand, I believe in personal prophesy, I am occasionally used of the Lord in that way, but I believe that kind of ministry will be confirmation, and not revelation!

You are his child and if he wants to **“SAY”** something to you he will not need to use a third party to do it! (It’s like preaching and reading someone’s mail, so to speak!)

While we explore this subject it is of ultimate importance for you to hear me say that God will NEVER **“SPEAK”** contrary to his written word!

When God speaks he does not always speak with a thundering voice from the sky!

Following 3 1/2 years of drought Elijah prays on Mt. Carmel and the fire of God falls. In the very next chapter, 1 Kings 19 Jezebel threatens to kill the prophet and we find him booked in the juniper Hilton of the wilderness, depressed, discouraged, and despondent, asking God to pull the plug on his life!

God does quite the opposite, he sent an angel to bake him a cake and bring him water. and the Bible say's in **1 Kings 19:8** ***"And he arose, and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that meat forty days and forty nights unto Horeb the mount of God."***

When Elijah gets to Horeb he rents a room at the Horeb Motel Six (A cave), and no one left a light on for him! Notice **1 Kings 19:11-12** ***"And the Lord said, Go forth, and stand upon the mount before the Lord. And, behold, the Lord passed by, and a great and strong wind rent the mountains, and brake in pieces the rocks before the Lord; but the Lord was not in the wind; and after the wind an earthquake; but the Lord was not in the earthquake: ¹²And after the earthquake a fire; but the Lord was not in the fire: and after the fire a still small voice."***
"O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!"

B. Now that we have discovered how God **"SPEAKS"** let us try to decide why people are not hearing from God.

They are not reading his word! I just wonder if I asked how many of you are going to read his word through this year, how many of you could respond in a positive manner without violating your conscience? (Ask people to close their eyes, and ask for a show of hands of how many are going to read their Bible through this

year!)

Every sermon I have preached for well over five years I have asked you to hold your Bible up and repeat a confession after me, and still there is a rather large percentage of this church who fail to bring their Bibles to the house of God on a consistent basis! If you don't carry it to church where else don't you take it!

Why do we fail to carry our Bibles? Could it be that it has become that unimportant? Could it be that our attitude in general toward His Word is why we are not hearing from God?

If the majority of those who sit in a truly Pentecostal church in the buckle of the Bible belt, cannot truthfully say that they are reading God's word on a consistent basis I wonder how inconsistent the rest of the population is?

I wonder how many situations would be handled before they became a major problem if people read their Bibles consistently? (There would probably be much less need for prayer chains, and counseling sessions!)

They are not listening! When Jesus spoke to the seven churches in Asia Minor, through John the Revelator from the rocky barren Island of Patmos, the one thing that was consistent throughout, was the phrase ***“He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches”!***

One of the things God has been dealing with me about recently is to do less talking and more listening. He wants me to develop a listening ear! (Have you ever talked with someone, and the whole time you were talking you could tell by the expression on their face that they were thinking about what they were going to say next?)

If you want to hear from God you must first place yourself in a position to hear from him! **Psalm 66:18** ***“If I regard***

(Harbor) iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear me.

Psalm 24:3-5 *“Who shall ascend into the hill of the Lord? or who shall stand in his holy place? He that hath clean hands, and a pure heart; who hath not lifted up his soul unto vanity, nor sworn deceitfully.^s He shall receive the blessing from the Lord, and righteousness from the God of his salvation.*”

C. What happens when God “**SPEAKS**”? The worlds are formed! Rain falls on an earth that has never seen rain before! Seas are dried up! The sun stands still! Armies are defeated without a shot being fired! Ladders reach from heaven to earth! Giants are killed with slingshots! Lepers are cleansed! The dead are raised to life! Blinded eyes are opened! Deaf ears are unstopped! That which was lost is now found! The lost are saved! The backslider is reclaimed! The empty are filled! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

IX. CONCLUSION

A. Vs. 8-18

Vs. 8 - In previous sermons we have pretty much covered vs. 8. For that reason I will not take a lot of time to deal with it today. Let me just briefly point out that other gods are **(1)** The product of man’s ingenuity. **(2)** Have no means of communication. **(3)** They are blind. **(4)** Cannot hear. **(5)** Have no sense of smell. **(6)** Do not possess the ability of touch. **(7)** Cannot move about. **(8)** They cannot speak with an audible voice. A god who has all of these limitations is severely handicapped. The truly sad part of all of this is that the scripture says “They that make them are like unto them.”

Vs. 9-11 - There are three words I want us to closely examine in these three verses of scripture **(1)** Trust **(2)** Help **(3)** Shield

(1) The word “**TRUST**” comes from the Hebrew word “**BATACH**”

(baw-takh'), and means to be confident or sure. This alludes to the kind of confidence a person who is living in a war zone would have when behind the walls of a mighty fortress, with all the fire power of the military protecting them, and armed guards patrolling the perimeter! The old song of the church say's " 'Tis so sweet to trust in Jesus". If only we could learn to do that. **"O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!"**

(2) The word **"HELP"** comes from the Hebrew word **"EZER"** (ay'-zer), which comes from the Hebrew word, **"AZAR"** (aw-zar'), and literally means to surround, protect, or aid. What happens to your confidence when you know that you are surrounded with the best help available? In the book of 2 Kings the sixth chapter the King of Syria is warring against the King of Israel. Every time the King of Syria sets a battle plan Elisha hears from God and gives the King of Israel very specific details concerning the impending attack, thus the plan is foiled. The King of Syria calls his troops together and accuses them of leaking confidential information to the King of Israel. Notice the response of the troops that day, **2 Kings 6:12** *"None of us, my lord the king, said one of his officers, but **Elisha**, the prophet who is in Israel, tells the king of Israel the very words you speak in your bedroom."*

Notice how the King of Syria responds to this information. **2 Kings 6:13-14** *"Go, find out where he is, the king ordered, so I can send men and capture him. The report came back: He is in Dothan. ¹⁴Then he sent horses and chariots and a strong force there. They went by night and surrounded the city."*

The next morning Elisha's servant walked outside and discovered this great army surrounding them, and he said to Elisha, *"Master, what are we going to do?"*

Listen to Elisha's words! **2 Kings 6:16-19** *"And he answered,*

Fear not: for they that be with us are more than they that be with them. ¹⁷And Elisha prayed, and said, Lord, I pray thee, open his eyes, that he may see. And the Lord opened the eyes of the young man; and he saw: and, behold, the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire round about Elisha. ¹⁸And when they came down to him, Elisha prayed unto the Lord, and said, Smite this people, I pray thee, with blindness. And he smote them with blindness according to the word of Elisha. ¹⁹And Elisha said unto them, This is not the way, neither is this the city: follow me, and I will bring you to the man whom ye seek. But he led them to Samaria.”

If you study the actions of Elisha here you are going to discover that he had tremendous confidence that he was going to receive Divine intervention and **“HELP”**! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

We sing a chorus occasionally that I absolutely love, and it says, “surround me O Lord. Surround me O Lord. Surround me O Lord, let thy presence fill this place.” If God’s presence fills your life, you will have all the **“HELP”** you will ever need!

Romans 8:31 *“What shall we then say to these things? If God be for us, who can be against us?”*

Over the years, this verse has troubled me somewhat because there seems to be a question of whether or not God is really for us! The Greek word, from which this word **“IF”** is derived, means Forasmuch as! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

Romans 8:31-39 *“What shall we then say to these things? If God be for us, who can be against us? ³²He that spared not his own Son, but delivered him up for us all, how shall he not with him also freely give us all things? ³³Who shall lay any thing to the charge of God's elect? It is God that*

justifieth. ³⁴Who is he that condemneth? It is Christ that died, yea rather, that is risen again, who is even at the right hand of God, who also maketh intercession for us. ³⁵Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶As it is written, For thy sake we are killed all the day long; we are accounted as sheep for the slaughter. ³⁷Nay, in all these things we are more than conquerors through him that loved us. ³⁸For I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come, ³⁹Nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.” “O GOD, WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

(3) The word “SHIELD” comes from the Hebrew word, “MAGEN” (maw-gane’). In it’s plural form it comes from the Hebrew word, “MEGINNAH” (meg-in-naw’), and means an implement of protection. This “SHIELD” was believed to be made from the scaly hide of the crocodile. This “SHIELD” was used by individuals for protection while they were doing battle with their enemies! **Ephes. 6:10-12** “Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might. ¹¹Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. ¹²For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places.”

2 Cor. 10:3-6 “For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh: ⁴(For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds;) ⁵Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of

Christ; ⁶And having in a readiness to revenge all disobedience, when your obedience is fulfilled.”

Ephes. 6:10-18 *“Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might. ¹¹Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. ¹²For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places. ¹³Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand. ¹⁴Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness; ¹⁵And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace; ¹⁶Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked. ¹⁷And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God: ¹⁸Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints;”*

Notice who the writer say’s these things are available to;

Psalms 115:9 *“O Israel, trust thou in the Lord: he is their help and their shield.”*

This basically say’s that the people at large, the commoners can expect the provision of the Lord! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

Psalms 115:10 *“O house of Aaron, trust in the Lord: he is their help and their shield.”*

The priesthood is covered! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

Psalm 115:11 *“Ye that fear the Lord, trust in the Lord: he is their help and their shield.”*

What does it mean to **“Fear the Lord”**? The word **“FEAR”** comes from the Hebrew word, **“YARE”** (yaw-ray’), and means **“REVERENT”**. The word **“REVERENT”** means a deep respect, mixed with wonder or love.

I was raised in a very strict atmosphere by parents who lived what they preached. There are things that they believed was wrong that I do not necessarily agree with. To this very day there are still things we do not do in the presence of our parents because of our respect for them.

I am afraid the **“FEAR”** of God is at an all time low. In this day there is very little respect for the things of God! (People think nothing of desecrating the house of God! Moving about at will during a service! Continuing a conversation during a manifestation of the Holy Spirit! Causing a scene over things they do not agree with!)

Where has the **“FEAR”** of God gone?

When we come to the place where we can **“FEAR”** God as we should, we will discover a new level of **“TRUST”** surfacing in our lives. Once this happens we will find a renewed confidence in his **“HELP”** and **“SHIELD”**!

According to this Scripture as long as we **“FEAR”** the Lord we are all covered! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

Vs. 12-18 - There are five words I want us to focus in on in these seven verses; (1) Mindful (2) Bless (3) Increase (4) Given (5) Praise

(1) Verse twelve begins with these words, **“The Lord hath been MINDFUL of us”**. The word **“MINDFUL”** comes from the Hebrew word **“ZAKAR”** (zaw-kar’), and means to be *marked, so as to be remembered*. **Isaiah 49:14-16** **“But Zion said, The**

Lord hath forsaken me, and my Lord hath forgotten me. ¹⁵Can a woman forget her sucking child, that she should not have compassion on the son of her womb? yea, they may forget, yet will I not forget thee. ¹⁶Behold, I have graven thee upon the palms of my hands; thy walls are continually before me.

Think about that, the God of the universe has written your name upon the palms of his hands, so that your name is always before him! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

Genesis 8:1 *“And God remembered Noah, and every living thing, and all the cattle that was with him in the ark: and God made a wind to pass over the earth, and the waters asswaged;”*

Genesis 19:29 *“And it came to pass, when God destroyed the cities of the plain, that God remembered Abraham, and sent Lot out of the midst of the overthrow, when he overthrew the cities in the which Lot dwelt.” (Genesis 18 - 50,45,40,30,20,10)*

Numbers 10:9 *“And if ye go to war in your land against the enemy that oppresseth you, then ye shall blow an alarm with the trumpets; and ye shall be remembered before the Lord your God, and ye shall be saved from your enemies.”*

“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

(2) Six times in Seven verses the word **“BLESS”** or some form of the word is used. That tells me that **“BLESSING”** is a very important part of the message being delivered here!

The word **“BLESS”** as it is used here comes from the Hebrew word **“BARAK”** (baw-rak’), and means to kneel as an act of adoration!

Notice **Psalms 115:12-13** *“The Lord hath been mindful of us:*

he will bless us; he will bless the house of Israel; he will bless the house of Aaron. ¹³*He will bless them that fear the Lord, both small and great.”*

I understand completely that we are to **“BLESS”** God! That we are to kneel before him in adoration. However in this scripture we are being told that God will *“kneel before us; He will kneel before the house of Israel; He will kneel before the house of Aaron; He will kneel before them that fear the Lord, both small and great!”* I must admit that when I first began to study this I had a most difficult time with it. However I began to think, He is my Father, I am His son. When I treat him with the respect he is so deserving of, it causes him to be so proud of me that the respect is reciprocated!

Let me explain it in this way: Have you ever seen a parent kneel on the floor and admire the actions and reactions of their children? This is the highlight of their life! So it is with our Heavenly Father! **“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”**

What the writer is saying to us here is that if we give God the proper respect and reverence, he will give us his undivided attention!

Think about how crazy parents and grandparents act when their offspring do something to make them proud!

Many times parents cannot see the flaws in their own children. (God speaking to satan about Job!)

God is my Heavenly Father and he is proud of me! This is the kind of love and **“BLESSING”** that: Jacob had for Joseph!

Jairus had for his daughter!

The Father had for the prodigal son!

Jochebed had for Moses!

Matthew 7:11 *"If you, then, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good gifts to those who ask him!"*

Psalm 84:10-12 *"For a day in thy courts is better than a thousand. I had rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God, than to dwell in the tents of wickedness. ¹¹For the Lord God is a sun and shield: the Lord will give grace and glory: no good thing will he withhold from them that walk uprightly. ¹²O Lord of hosts, blessed is the man that trusteth in thee."*

Our Heavenly Father is looking for a reason to "BLESS" us! **2 Chron. 16:9** *"For the eyes of the Lord run to and fro throughout the whole earth, to shew himself strong in the behalf of them whose heart is perfect toward him. Herein thou hast done foolishly: therefore from henceforth thou shalt have wars."*

"O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!"

(3) As we move forward here, bear in mind that everything I am saying is contingent upon proper reverence and respect for God!

Notice **Psalm 115:14** *"The Lord shall increase you more and more, you and your children."*

The word "INCREASE" as it is used here comes from the Hebrew word, "YACAPH" (yaw-saf), and means to add to, or to make larger or more powerful.

God's promise to Abraham!

Look at the way God performed for Joseph! He named his second Son Ephraim, who by the way was born in the land of Egypt! The name Ephraim means double fruit, and Joseph said that he named him Ephraim because God had caused him to be fruitful in the land of his affliction!

The point the writer is attempting to get across to his readers here is that those who have the proper respect and reverence for God can expect God to do the same for them! He is no respecter of persons!

Most people can prosper when times are good, but it requires the hand of God upon our lives for us to “**INCREASE**” in the worst of times! Those who walk with God as they should seem to possess the uncanny ability to turn the worst of times, into the best of times! (When dealt lemons, they make lemonade! When their cherry tree blows down they can the cherries, and plant the seeds and raise an orchard!)

“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

4) Psalm 115:15-16 *“Ye are blessed of the Lord which made heaven and earth. ¹⁶The heaven, even the heavens, are the Lord's: but the earth hath he given to the children of men.”*

The word “**GIVEN**” as it is used here comes from the Hebrew word “**NATHAN**” (naw-than’), and means to bestow, or ascribe!

Before we go into this, remember, these things are being promised to those who have proper reverence and respect for God!

Since the day’s of Adam, God has “**GIVEN**” man dominion over the earth! Remember Noah? He commanded the animal kingdom to come into the Ark in pairs of two, and they did!

God has given man dominion over the earth, but as long as ungodly people exercise control things are going to be out of balance!

Proverbs 14:34 “*Righteousness exalteth a nation: but sin is a reproach to any people.*”

It is my personal belief that in these last day’s God wants his people to step forward and exercise their rightful place of dominion in the Earth;
Spiritually!

Morally!

Politically! Stop and consider how many common ordinary people, who were righteous, were placed in prominent places of power by an act of God! (Moses! Joseph! David! Daniel! etc...!)

I heard someone say when Mike Huckabee was running for Governor, that they did not think a preacher should get into politics! Why not? When they accepted the call to preach did that make them any less of a citizen? I am for him being in politics!

I’m not only for him being in politics, I’m for deacons, trustees, Sunday school teachers, bus driver, butlers, bakers, and candlestick makers being in politics!

Financially! **Proverbs 13:22** “*A good man leaveth an inheritance to his children's children: and the wealth of the sinner is laid up for the just.*”

It is time for the Church of the living God to rise up and take back what the devil has stolen from us!

This Scripture say’s that God has “GIVEN” the earth to those who reverence him and respect him as they should!

“O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!”

5) Psalm 115:17-18 “*The dead praise not the Lord, neither*

any that go down into silence. ¹⁸But we will bless the Lord from this time forth and for evermore. Praise the Lord.

The word “**PRAISE**” as it is used here, comes from the Hebrew word “**HALAL**” (haw-lal’), and means to give a clear sound: To shine: Make a show: To boast: To clamor foolishly: To rave: To celebrate!

Can I tell you that God wants us to “**PRAISE**” Him?

How are we to “**PRAISE**” God? **Psalm 150:1-6** “*Praise ye the Lord. Praise God in his sanctuary: praise him in the firmament of his power. ²Praise him for his mighty acts: praise him according to his excellent greatness. ³Praise him with the sound of the trumpet: praise him with the psaltery and harp. ⁴Praise him with the timbrel and dance: praise him with stringed instruments and organs. ⁵Praise him upon the loud cymbals: praise him upon the high sounding cymbals. ⁶Let every thing that hath breath praise the Lord. Praise ye the Lord.”*

There will be a lot of people who will try to get you to tone down your worship to God, but let me tell you that you have a whole lot more Scripture for being a radical, on fire, worshipper of God, than they have for being so quiet that no one can detect whether or not God is working in their lives! “**O GOD WHO IS LIKE UNTO THEE!**”